completely usurped the public institutions where they have advanced their own arbitrary interests,'[189] so that 'Slovenia's model of de facto political and economic continuity with the pre-democratic system has permitted its elites to hold on to control of the country without any openly authoritarian tendencies, capture of the state or constitutional backsliding.'[190]

This quite unique 'leftist Orbánisation' has thus gone largely unnoticed. Essential in this was the role of the media, as it was the 'elite's economic and political control over the media', which 'proved decisive. For it was exactly the media with a strong left-centre bias which facilitated, justified and defended the conquering of the Slovenian public and private sphere by the leftist post-socialist elite.'[191] Contrary to what is normally expected of the media in a liberal democracy 'the impact of the press on the functioning of Slovenia's constitutional democracy and the rule of law has been in the prevailing sense weak or even negative. The Slovenian media has been, with few exceptions, one of the actors most responsible for the deficient workings of the country's constitutional democracy as it has at different levels directly and indirectly affected electoral process, thereby interfering with the proper functioning of all the three primary branches of government. Even more conspicuous has been the role of RTV Slovenia [public radio and TV broadcaster], which has in recent decades failed to provide independent and pluralist news reporting.'[192] Given the role that the media are supposed to have in a well-functioning liberal democracy, such criticism is indeed devastating.

The authors try to look for the root causes of this rarely heard version of what happened in what in so many respects has been the model among the Central European countries. Among them are 'systematic and widespread human rights violations (1945-90)', i.e. during the communist period and as described in the first part of this book. Furthermore, after the changes the 'Constitutional Court has […] contributed to the formation of the formal standards of the rule of law and human rights', however, 'its impact on the reform of the mentality of civil servants, public employees and holders of public offices and the daily appreciation of the rule of law in practice has so far been limited […] Slovenia, as most CEE countries, therefore appears to suffer from the fact that liberal democratic values have not been fully internalised due to resistance from institutional elites and ordinary people'. For this reason, 'it has been very difficult to move from the rule of law de